

Nokia & NFC

Nokia launches NFC Hub to help in business development growth. <http://bit.ly/oQ0lkx>

ASUS Zenbook UX21 Teardown

Asus' latest ultra-slim laptop, the 11-inch Zenbook was taken apart to pieces. <http://bit.ly/ob2c68>

Tried & tested



Z68 Motherboards	Under ₹10,000				₹10,000 to ₹14,000					
Brand	Biostar	ASRock	Gigabyte	ASUS	Intel	ZOTAC	ASUS	ASUS	ASUS	
Model No.	TZ68K+	Z68 Extreme3 Gen3	Z68AP-D3	P8Z68 MPro	DZ68D8	Z68 ITX A-E	P8Z68-V LE	P8Z68-V	Maximus IV GENE Z	
Price (in ₹)	7,990	8,800	9,880	9,901	10,000	10,600	10,994	13,041	13,110	
Features and Specs (Out of 70)	24.57	33.32	18.62	25.62	16.87	18.48	26.04	30.24	34.16	
Board Layout (Out of 10)	6.5	7.4	7.3	6.6	6	6	6.6	7.6	7.3	
Build Quality (Out of 15)	11.1	12.825	10.95	10.95	5.25	9.9	11.25	12.825	13.65	
Package Bundle (Out of 5)	1.2	1	1.2	1.2	0.6	1.2	1.2	1.6	1.3	
Overall (Out of 100)	43.37	54.545	38.07	44.37	28.72	35.58	45.09	52.265	56.41	
Specifications										
Max. Memory Supported (GB) / No of DIMMs	4 / 32	4 / 32	4 / 32	4 / 32	4 / 32	2 / 16	4 / 32	4 / 32	4 / 32	
No. of SATA 2 / SATA 3 / eSATA Ports	4/2/0	4/2/0	4/2/0	4/2/1	2/2/1	2/2/0	4/2/0	4/2/0	4/2/0	
No. of PCI Express x16 Graphics Slots	2	2	1	1	1	1	2	3	2	
Multi GPU (SLI/CrossFire) Support	Y/Y	Y/Y	N/Y	Y/Y	N/N	N/N	Y/Y	Y/Y	Y/Y	
Optical S/PDIF Port / LAN Port	N/1	Y/1	N/1	Y/1	N/1	Y/2	Y/1	Y/1	Y/1	
Integrated Wi-Fi (Y/N)	N	N	N	N	N	Y	N	N	N	
No. of Ports: USB 2.0/USB 3.0	2/2	4/2	4/2	4/2	6/2	4/2	4/2	6/2	8/2	
No. of Ports: FireWire / eSATA	0/0	0/1	0/0	0/1	1/1	0/0	0/0	0/1	0/2	
Display Ports DVI / VGA / HDMI / Display Port	Y/Y/Y/N	Y/Y/Y/N	N/N/Y/N	Y/Y/Y/Y	Y/N/Y/Y	N/N/Y/N	Y/Y/Y/N	Y/Y/Y/N	N/N/Y/N	
Power and Reset Buttons (Y/N)	Y	Y	N	N	N	Y	N	Y	Y	
UEFI BIOS / Lucid Virtu (Y/N)	Y/Y	Y/Y	N/Y	Y/Y	N/Y	N/N	Y/Y	Y/Y	Y/Y	
Headers: USB 2.0 / USB 3.0	3/0	4/0	3/0	5/0	4/0	2/1	4/1	3/1	2/1	
POST debug LED / Button for overclocking	N/N	Y/N	N/N	N/N	N/N	Y/N	N/N	N/N	Y/Y	
Total Fan Connectors	3	6	4	3	3	2	4	6	5	
Form Factor	ATX	ATX	ATX	MicroATX	ATX	Mini ITX	ATX	ATX	MicroATX	
Board Layout (So 10)										
Region around CPU / SATA Port Location	6.5/5	7/7	6.5/7	7/5	6.5/5	6/5	7/5	7/7.5	6.5/7	
Placement of Memory Modules	8	8	8	8	6	7	8	8	8	
Graphics Card Slot and PCI Slots	8	8	8	8	7	7	8	8	8	
Build Quality										
All Solid State Caps (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	N	Y	Y	Y	Y	
Button Build / Feedback	4/8	7/8	NA	NA	NA	4/6	NA	7/8	8/8	
VRM/Southbridge Heatsink Quality	4/5	7/7	5.5/6	5.5/6	0/5	5.5/5	5.5/7	7/7	8.5/8	
Package Bundle										
No of SATA Cables	4	2	4	4	2	4	4	4	3	
USB 3 Bracket	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	N	
CrossFire / SLI Bridge	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1	1	
Performance (Only for reference)										
Cinebench R11.5 (OpenGL / CPU (all cores))	51.74/6.66	51.85/6.68	52.42/6.79	51.19/6.83	55.91/6.98	49.75/6.5	51.42/6.87	51.67/6.76	52.04/6.83	
3D Mark Overall	4150	4109	4154	4174	4178	4146	4182	4180	4179	
WinRAR 4.0 (Multi-threaded)	3503	3509	3505	3516	3687	3491	3529	3535	3515	
100 MB file Video Encoding (VOB-DivX 7) (sec)	20.28	19.35	20.79	19.42	19.39	20.52	19.52	19.6	19.51	
File Transfer (Sequential / Assorted) (MB/s)	45.7/48.5	41.2/47.2	47.5/48.5	41.2/41.2	46.8/47.5	44.8/49.1	46.2/46.2	46.38/47.1	47.3/49.2	
USB 3.0 Sequential Write/Read (MB/s)	66.1/84.8	64.8/88.1	66.7/88.3	65.6/86.5	65.6/83.5	66.5/85.4	65.4/86.6	67.1/85.5	65.1/85.5	
USB 3.0 Assorted Write/Read (MB/s)	44.7/70.2	44.8/73.7	47.4/71.4	44.4/72.2	44.6/67.5	46.9/72.7	44.4/77.7	44.8/71.8	47.6/71.6	
Game										
Resident Evil 5 (1680x1050, med)	178.2	176.2	180.2	180.2	190.8	175.4	181.2	181.9	180.2	
STALKER: COP (1680x1050, med)	164.7	164.9	165.6	163.1	164.2	163.2	163.7	164.8	165	

On-board RoG features are also quite exhaustive and give you many ways to overclock or tweak your way through. RoG Connect allows you to connect your motherboard to a notebook and tune it on the fly. With iDirect, you can

do the tweaking using an iPad or even an iPhone, a decent feature to show off to your pals. A BIOS switch allows you to maintain a copy of your stable BIOS while you tinker with the other BIOS.

The Z68X-UD7-B3 is Giga-

byte's flagship Z68 board and comes with the traditional bells and whistles of all UD7 boards. A black-coloured PCB densely packed with ICs provides a perfect background to the grey/golden heatsinks. All

the heatsinks are connected via a heat pipe which assists in heat dissipation. Compared to G1 Sniper2, this board has a good assortment of back I/O panel ports. A dedicated Start button and POST